



Battlefield 1 gameplay

Battlefield 1 will be releasing in October, but here's how the newer weather and the explosions in the game look. <http://dgit.in/Btflld1GP>



New Netflix icon

No, Netflix is not introducing a new logo. But hey, here's their new icon. <http://dgit.in/NFXicon>

Action Cams



Magical discoveries from the land of GoPros



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When have you ever used your DSLR or camcorder to shoot more than a few minutes of video clips in a controlled indoor or outdoor environment? Chances are not too many times. As great as its video quality may be, try holding an iPhone while you're standing at the door of a Mumbai local (actually, don't try that, you'd be risking your life) just to capture what it feels like to be in the moment? If you want to record videos of your trekking adventures, would you hold a DSLR in your hand while you're roughing it out in the woods? Or if you're going to go rafting or scuba diving, would you carry a companion along just to hold the camcorder and shoot your videos for you? If the answer to all these rhetorical questions is no, then my friend you need to go buy an action camera.

An action camera negates all the inconveniences of a traditional camera. It's lightweight, easy to attach through a wide variety of mounting stands (on your helmet, on your bike's handle, etc), can capture 60fps 1080p video (some can also shoot 4K UHD videos, if you're inter-

ested), and easy to operate. What's more, a wide variety of the most popular action cameras are waterproof, and almost all of them come with watertight cases that can be used in deep-sea diving scenarios. Action cameras don't have a lot of physical controls on them – no interchangeable lenses, too – and that's part of the point. With a fixed lens and aperture, action cams are meant for capturing a wide angle shot in almost all video scenarios, and almost all of them have supported companion apps on smartphones in case you need advanced functionalities for any occasion. Despite being tiny and small, action cams are built tough and meant to be used in an outdoor environment, and therefore come with as little moving parts as can be managed.

Having read about all the glittering positives of an action cam, time for some cold hard reality. It's important to remember that action cams can't replace your existing DSLR or camcorder; they're meant to be used in scenarios where DSLRs or camcorders fail or become unwieldy. Therefore, despite being capable of crisp, high-quality 1080p videos, action cams operate within tight optical constraints. For example, because capturing the maximum field of view is

the most go-to priority of an action cam, captured videos (or images) often suffer from a fisheye effect, which has become sort of a signature trait of footage captured from an action cam. The industry and action cam enthusiasts have gotten used to looking past this optical aberration, but it may not go down too well among photo and video connoisseurs.

Battery drain on action cams is also something you need to know about. While, yes, most popular action cams easily offer between 1 to 3 hours of video capture time (depending on the quality of the video being captured, of course), weather can impact battery drain more acutely than you'd think. For instance, in really cold environments (close to 0 degree C), GoPro cameras have been known to not work for more than a few minutes due to its battery juices starting to freeze over. Even extreme heat – like what some parts of Western India experienced this summer with temps over 50 degree C – can throw sensitive action cam batteries into a tizzy. I don't know why this behaviour is so unique to action cams alone, or whether it stems from an observation bias restricted to the category of these devices, but I'll let you guys know more as soon as I have more data to share. While battery replacements are available aplenty, popping them in (or out) isn't as easy on action cams in comparison to most DSLRs or camcorders.

As far as which action cams to invest in, GoPro cameras pretty much rule the market. Checkout their Hero series of action cams, offering versatility and functionality in a small, light form factor. I've had a lot of fun playing around with one over the last couple of months, personally. Also checkout the Polaroid Cube, the tiny camera we mounted on the IO Walk hoverboard we tested a few months ago. Its recorded footage seemed really cool through that perspective but doesn't hold up in comparison to the far superior GoPro quality. 